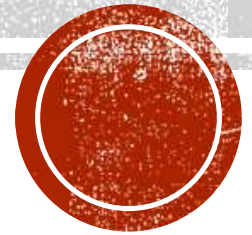
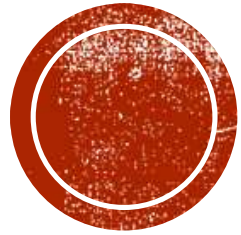


ESSAYS FOCUSING ON ADVANTAGES AND DISADVANTES





IN THIS TYPE OF ESSAY, A TOPIC IS EXAMINED FROM OPPOSING POINTS OF VIEW, AND ITS ADVANTAGES AND DISADVANTAGES ARE OUTLINED.

UNDERSTAND THE PROMPT

People now have the freedom to work and live anywhere in the world due to the development of communication technology and transportation.

What are the advantages and disadvantages of this trend?

People now have the freedom to work and live anywhere in the world due to the development of communication technology and transportation.

Do the advantages of this development outweigh the disadvantages?

OR

Will this have more positive or negative impacts?

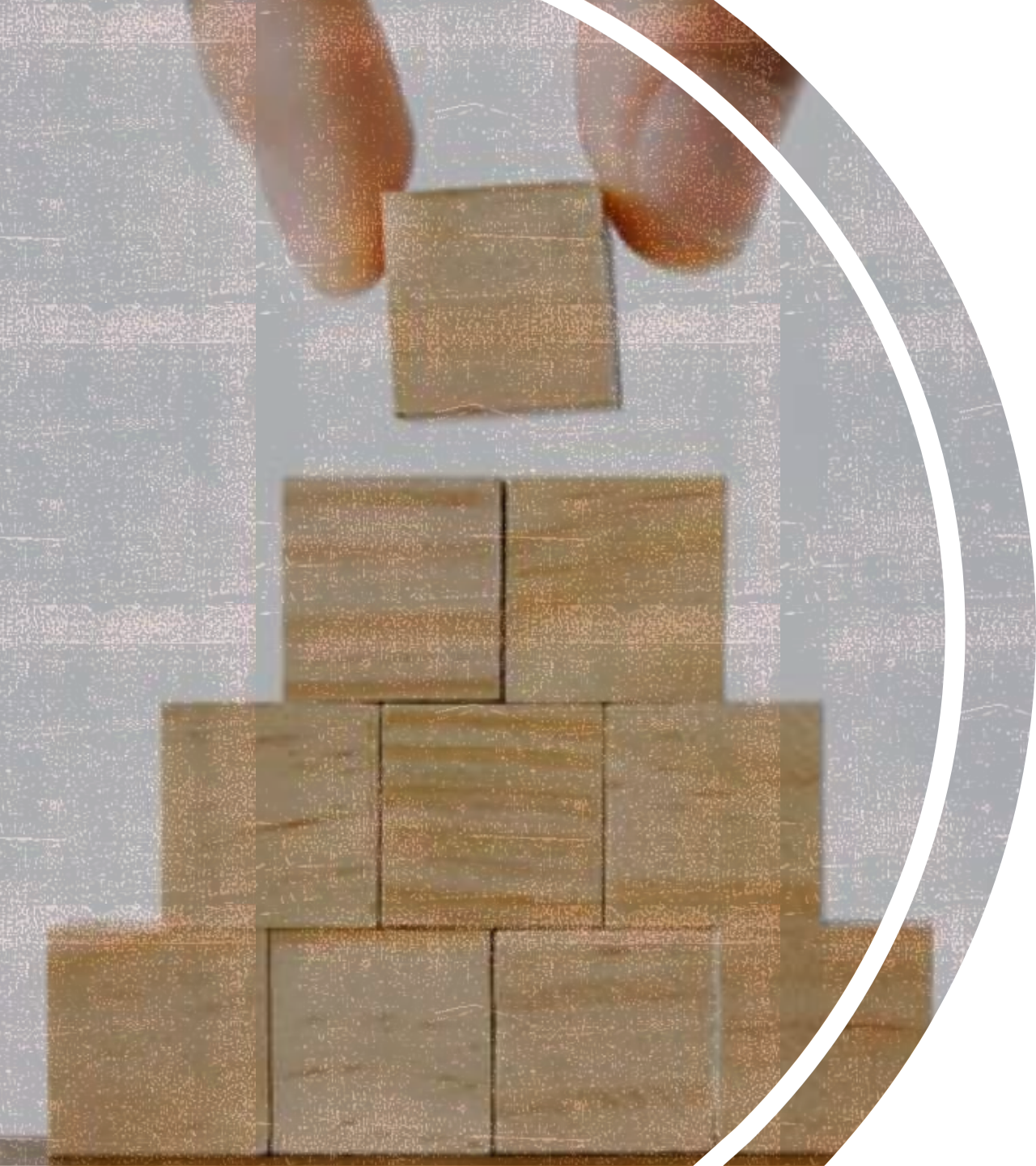
People now have the freedom to work and live anywhere in the world due to the development of communication technology and transportation.

What are the advantages of this trend?

OR

What are the disadvantages of this trend?





STRUCTURE

- **Introduction**
- **Main body**
- **Conclusion**

Let's explore the structure through the following essay question:

Many people nowadays change career more frequently than ever before while others stick to a single job. What are the advantages and disadvantages of changing career? (400 words)





INTRODUCTION

- In this part, the topic is introduced. The following techniques can be exploited:

General statement:

- paraphrasing the question
- introducing the topic
- giving background information
- **Thesis Statement:**
- Direct or indirect



INTRODUCTION:

- Introduction:
- ***Paraphrase the question:*** It is not unusual for today's generation to have many different jobs as there are so many different job opportunities available. It is becoming more and more common for people to change their jobs frequently.
- ***Give your opinion:*** Changing career can help people to develop their skills/lifestyle and job satisfaction.
- ***Thesis statement:*** Although there are several benefits of switching jobs, it is also associated with a few downside.



MAIN BODY

Present the points **for** the issue (the advantages), along with your justifications or examples. (2-3 arguments + 2-3 examples)

Present the points **against** the issue (the disadvantages) with supporting sentences. (2-3 arguments + 2-3 examples)



MAIN BODY- ADVANTAGES PARAGRAPH

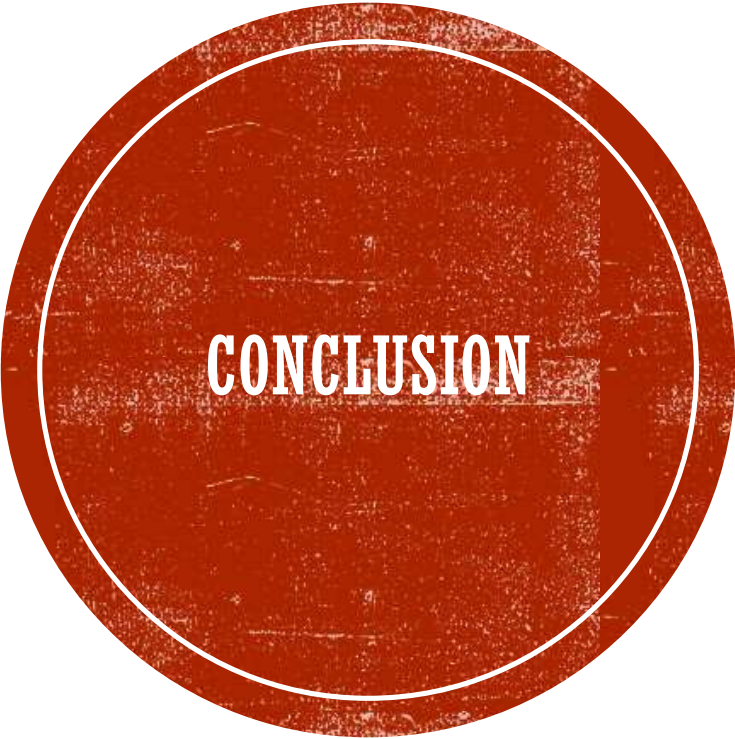
- ***Start with a topic sentence:***
- There are many advantages to changing your occupation.
- **Explain what you mean: (supporting idea)**
- One of the primary reasons people change jobs is to change their lifestyle in the hope to create a better work life balance.
- **Give examples : 2-3 supporting details**
- For instance, after having worked for many years, some people are not so passionate about their careers anymore because they have become tired of the routine. Therefore, in this case, it would pay off to switch the job to the one that provides the person with a better work-life balance. As a result, workers could be healthier as well as happier.
- Another major benefit of deciding to change the field of work is the ability to find a more suited occupation. For example, if a person's circumstances have changed – perhaps they now have children they may wish to change their job to fit their new routine. Therefore, they would rather work in a work place in which it is possible to have a flexible schedule. This in turn helps them to spend more time with their new born kid or make it possible for parents to rotate turns in taking care of their child.



MAIN BODY- DISADVANTAGE PARAGRAPH.

- ***Start with a topic sentence:***
- On the contrary, there are some negatives to switching one's career path.
- ***Explain what you mean: (supporting idea)***
- One of the biggest hurdles when changing roles is lack of skills and experience.
- **Give examples : No more than 2-3 supporting details**
- Some jobs have some very specific specifications which can make it difficult to secure the job or become competitive without these qualifications. Thus, it may be necessary for an individual to spend time retraining or studying to gain the necessary qualifications needed. Spending extra time on acquiring new skills can be stressful and time consuming.
- Another drawback is that the relationships with the current colleagues could be jeopardized. That is to say, it could become much more difficult to keep in contact with the coworkers when not working in the same place. That is the reason why some people forget their former friends.





CONCLUSION

- In the final paragraph give your own opinion and/or a balanced summary of the topic.
- To make the ending of the composition more effective, use one of the following techniques:
 - **state a personal opinion (avoid using personal pronouns)**
 - **give the reader something to consider**

CONCLUSION

- ***Start with a topic sentence:***
- In conclusion, it is apparent that changing career path has many benefits and for many is regarded as a positive experience, however the negatives should definitely be considered seriously if anybody is contemplating a career change.
- ***Sum up your main points – which outweighs the other?***
- For many the benefits outweigh the drawbacks, there is definitely more opportunities and in today's society it is no longer expected to stay in the same job for life. People can manage to work in the new place and find enough time to socialise with former friends from the previous job and spend quality time with family members. It is hoped that people will be braver in terms of pursuing their life goals instead of staying in a job which makes them unhappy.



VOCABULARY

The following words are often used in essays which discuss advantages and disadvantages:

Positive points – advantages, pros, benefits, arguments in favour, a positive effect

Negative points – disadvantages, cons, drawbacks, arguments against, a negative effect

Tip: Do not include opinion words (I believe, I think, etc) in the introduction or the main body of the essay.



OPENING PHRASES

Many/some people claim/believe that...

There is no denying that...

It is often said that.../ Many people claim that

These days.../ Nowadays.../ In this day and age...

It goes without saying that...

It is universally accepted that...

People are divided in their opinion regarding...

.... is one of the most important issues...

..... is often discussed yet rarely understood

..... is a hot debated topic that often divides opinion

Whether or is a controversial issue..



LINKING WORDS

To list and add points: Firstly/In the first place/To start/To begin with/ First and foremost .../Secondly/ Thirdly/Finally/Last; Last... but not least/ In addition/Furthermore/Moreover/Besides/What's more/Not only....but also /on top of that/ As well/ Also



To introduce or list advantages: The first/main/most important advantage of/; One/another/an additional advantage of/One point of view in favour of/It is often suggested/believed/argued that /Some/many people suggest/feel/argue that ...; etc



To introduce or list disadvantages: The main/most important disadvantage/drawback of/ One/Another/An additional disadvantage/negative effect of /One point/argument against; etc.



LINKING WORDS



To introduce examples/reasons/results: For example/instance; To show/give an example; To illustrate; Another factor to consider; Another point worth noting is; Such as; like; In particular; Therefore; For this reason; Because; As; Since; As a result; etc



To show contrast: On the other hand; However; Still; But; Nonetheless; Nevertheless; Although; Even though; Despite/In spite of (the fact that); Meanwhile, While, etc



To introduce a conclusion: In conclusion; In summary, On the whole, To conclude/sum up; All in all; Finally; Last; All things considered; Taking everything into account/ consideration; Considering all of the above,



STYLE

- **Characteristics of formal style include:**
- Long forms (It is, does not, cannot, etc)
- More sophisticated vocabulary (no colloquial expressions should be used)
- Use of the passive rather than the active voice (e.g. 'something should be done' instead of 'we should do something', etc)



BRAINSTORMING



Every time you start writing an essay on advantages and disadvantages, brainstorm for about 2-3 minutes.

Think of 3 advantages (plus an example for each of them) and 3 disadvantages (plus an example for each of them).

Do not start writing straight away!

Now, let's practice: Check practice handout

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